Proton Decay in SU(7) Grand Gauge-Higgs Unification: An Obstruction, Its Minimal Escapes, and the One Row of Their Table 1 That Can Pay for Them (Part VI)

High-energy physics · grand gauge-Higgs unification

Carles Marín

Statements

Observation 1 — a partial match is more dangerous than none 4

Proposition 1 — the identity that decides it 5

Proposition 2 — a real representation under diagonal ±1 parities furnishes no chiral generation 6

Observation 2 — the permissive reading is theirs, not a licence we take 8

Proposition 3 — the rule in closed form 8

Observation 3 — the exclusion list above is the one-loop list, and it is not the whole space 9

Observation 4 — the guard lied first, and it is recorded 10

At a glance

What the paper contributes

Komori and Maru's six-dimensional SU(7) grand gauge-Higgs model leaves proton decay to future work. Working inside their construction and with their own equations, the paper finds an obstruction, classifies the minimal escapes and selects one row of their Table 1 as the benchmark to compute next; it does not deliver that model.

- **An obstruction at one generation.** Three anomaly channels force $X_Q = -1/6$, where $U(1)' = T_{3L} + Y - (B - L)$ identically and the four dimension-6 $|\Delta B| = 1$ operators are neutral; two further channels require a right-handed neutrino of charge -1, which only a **28** supplies (rows (2) and (3)).
- **The escapes, inside their own group.** A ladder $\mathrm{extra}(L) = (1 - k)/2$ and the identity $[SU(2)_L]^2 U(1)' = \tfrac{1}{2} \Sigma_j A_j$ (Proposition 1): fourteen anomaly-free three-generation assignments, two of which fit their tensors. The **48** cannot host a generation, because under diagonal ± 1 parities a real representation is vector-like (Proposition 2, a specialisation of Gogoladze–Mimura–Nandi).
- **The bill, in eighths.** $V''(0) = -\pi^2 \zeta(3) D$ with D rational per multiplet ($\mathbf{84}^{(+,+)} \mapsto 5/4$, $\mathbf{48}^{(+,+)} \mapsto 0$): only case (2) satisfies both necessary conditions, at one-loop curvature.
- **A selection rule in closed form.** Protection fails iff $q_\varphi = |A_j|/n$ (Proposition 3); $q_\varphi = 3/2$ protects for every half-integer brane-quark charge.
- **The instrument, audited.** Their $\alpha_{\min}$ column is not reproduced (an open question, not a defect claim); the verdict holds on a wedge of multiplicative repairs, and two-loop safety is left open.

🚀 **Start here: Proposition 1**: the left-handed SU(2) anomaly of U(1)′ is half the sum of the proton-operator charges.

Main results:

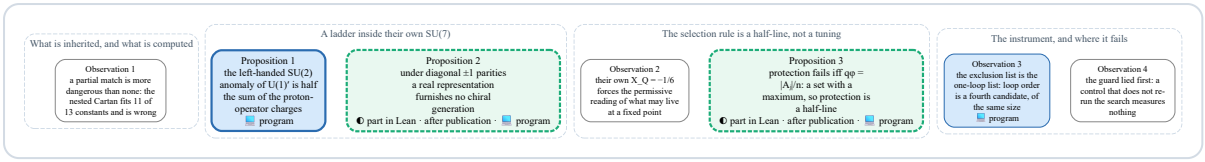
- **Proposition 1**: the left-handed SU(2) anomaly of U(1)′ is half the sum of the proton-operator charges
- **Proposition 2**: under diagonal ±1 parities a real representation furnishes no chiral generation
- **Proposition 3**: protection fails iff qφ = |Aⱼ|/n: a set with a maximum, so protection is a half-line

7 results | ✅ **0** entirely in Lean | ◐ **2** partly in Lean

💻 **4** checked by a program | written proof only | (a result can carry several tags)

🗺️ Map of the results (click a box to go to it)

Dependencies in the written proof: an arrow A → B means that this proof of B uses A. Every result rests on its written proof; the tags record what was checked besides, and each statement's “Evidence & scope” block says how far. The colour of a box is its strongest tag, in the order above; the tags in the box give the rest. Boxes with a thick border are the main results; click a box to read the statement.



📐 Setting (copied from the paper, §2)

The model of [1] is six-dimensional $SU(7)$ on $S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2 \times S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2$. Its orbifold parities are their eqs. (11)–(13),

$$P_6 = \mathrm{diag}(+,+,+,-,-,-,-), \qquad P_5 = \mathrm{diag}(+,+,+,+,+,-,-), \qquad P_5' = \mathrm{diag}(+,$$

the Standard-Model fermions are localised at fixed points (their eqs. (43)–(47)), and the bulk carries 6D Dirac fermions in **7**, **28**, **48** and **84** whose only role is the one-loop Higgs potential. Their Wilson-line vacuum leaves $SU(3)_C \times U(1)_{\mathrm{em}}$ together with one extra abelian factor, their eq. (79),

$$U(1)': \qquad T^{15} - \tfrac{\sqrt{3}}{3} T^{24} + \tfrac{\sqrt{6}}{3} T^{35} = \tfrac{1}{2}\,\mathrm{diag}(0,0,0,1,-1,1,-1),$$

which they say must be broken by a $U(1)'$-charged 4D scalar on a fixed point. *(§3)* Write X_Q for the $U(1)'$ charge of the brane quark doublet. […] The four dimension-6 $|\Delta B| = 1$ operators then carry a single $U(1)'$ charge

$$A = 3X_Q + \tfrac{1}{2}.$$

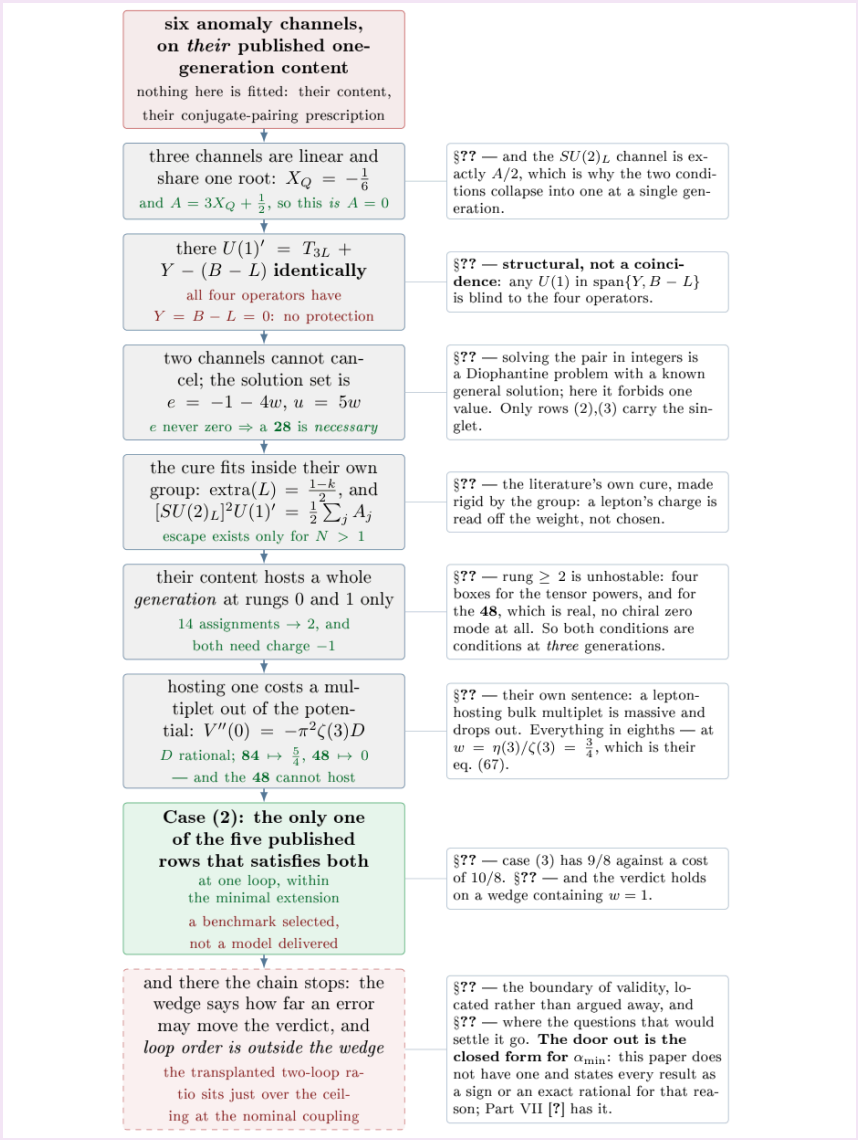
(§4) $\mathrm{extra}(L) = \frac{1-k}{2}$ — a ladder spaced by $1/2$ and indexed by how many index-7 boxes the multiplet carries. *(§6)* A vacuum expectation value of charge q_φ does not destroy the symmetry: it breaks $U(1)'$ to a discrete subgroup, and an operator of charge A can be dressed with $\langle\varphi\rangle$ insertions only if $A/q_\varphi \in \mathbb{Z}$.

1 Introduction

No numbered statement in this section.

Its figures and tables are below; its text is in the paper, p. 2.

Figure 1



The chain, and it is one chain: every statement in this paper descends from the six anomaly channels evaluated on [1] 's own content. Left, the thread; right, what each link buys and where it is done. Read top-down it is an *obstruction* (the first three links, which depend on no extension of ours), then a *classification of the escapes* (the next two, which assume three generations and their inventory), then a *benchmark* (the next two). The green box selects the row worth computing in full; it does not compute it. The dashed box is not a link but the edge of the chain.

2 What is inherited, and what is computed

Observation 1. (a partial match is more dangerous than none) p. 6

The obvious Cartan for their generator labels — the nested chain $SU(2) \subset SU(3) \subset \cdots \subset SU(7)$, whose diagonal generators sit at $3, 8, 15, 24, 35, 48$, where theirs sit — reproduces *eleven of the thirteen* constants of their eq. (54) and fails on the three diagonal ones. It reads as "their paper has two errors in the diagonal sector." It is not: the guess is wrong, refuted by their own eqs. (78) and (79), and it puts T^{48} — which they state commutes with the Wilson line — on a generator that does not.

> 🆕 **Classical and new:** the paper: the guess «reads as “their paper has two errors in the diagonal sector.” It is not: the guess is wrong, refuted by their own eqs. (78) and (79)» (§2).

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

3 All six channels, and what they force

No numbered statement in this section.

It is prose only (no statement, figure or table): read it in the paper, p. 7.

4 A ladder inside their own $SU(7)$

Proposition 1. (the identity that decides it) p. 9

> *For N generations with proton-operator charges $A_j = 3a_j + l_j$,*
>
> $$[SU(2)_L]^2\, U(1)' = \tfrac{1}{2}\sum_j A_j \qquad \text{exactly.}$$

> 🆕 **Classical and new:** the paper lists it among what is ours (§9); at N = 1 it is the entry 3X_Q/2 + 1/4 = A/2 of the anomaly table; the family-dependent cure it mirrors is Lee–Ma [FamilyU1].

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

💡 **In plain words (commentary, not part of the paper)**

1. Give each of N generations a proton-operator charge $A_j = 3a_j + l_j$ under the leftover $U(1)'$. Then the mixed anomaly $[SU(2)_L]^2\, U(1)'$ is exactly half of $\sum_j A_j$. 2. Why it matters: anomaly cancellation asks for $\sum_j A_j = 0$, and proton protection asks for $A_j \neq 0$ for every j. With one generation these are the same equation, so the published one-generation model cannot have both: that is the obstruction of §3, where the $SU(2)_L$ channel is $\frac{3}{2}X_Q + \frac{1}{4} = A/2$. With three generations a sum can vanish with no term vanishing, so a family-dependent charge escapes, and inside $SU(7)$ the lepton charges come from the ladder $\mathrm{extra}(L) = (1-k)/2$. 3. The paper obtains the identity by summing the anomaly state by state over the generations. The family-dependent cure itself is Lee and Ma’s; what the paper claims is the identity and the ladder inside this model. Imposing all six channels leaves 14 assignments, of which exactly two fit inside the model’s own tensors, and both need a singlet of charge -1.

🛡️ **Evidence & scope**

- **Program:** the ladder extra(L) = (1−k)/2, the identity summed state by state over N generations, the 14 anomaly-free assignments. `scripts/su7_family_u1.py`
- **Program:** the 14 assignments re-derived by an independent path, and the two that fit their tensors. `scripts/su7_realisable.py`

- **Program:** the six anomaly channels on the published one-generation content (and a Sage re-derivation, per §3). `scripts/su7_anomaly_channels.py`

Proposition 2.

(a real representation under diagonal ± 1 parities furnishes no chiral generation)

p. 10

> *Let the orbifold parities P_5, P_5' act diagonally on the indices of the fundamental, so that a component of a bulk multiplet survives in the multiplet of parities (η, η') iff $P_5 P_5' = \eta\eta'$ and then carries 4D chirality $-\eta\, P_5$ (their eqs. (37)–(40)). Then for a real representation the surviving spectrum is vector-like, with no chiral state at either choice of (η, η').*

Lean · ours, in part **show**

added to the Lean repository after publication (21-oct-2026): the pairing (i, j̄) ↦ (j, ī) for diagonal ±1 parities, and the counts 18/18, 24/24 with the controls 10 and 34

- `GaugeHiggsUnification.SU7RealPairing.adjoint_vectorLike`
- `GaugeHiggsUnification.SU7RealPairing.adjoint_unpaired_eq_zero`
- `GaugeHiggsUnification.SU7RealPairing.adjoint_survivors_pp`
- `GaugeHiggsUnification.SU7RealPairing.adjoint_survivors_pm`
- `GaugeHiggsUnification.SU7RealPairing.sym2_unpaired`
- `GaugeHiggsUnification.SU7RealPairing.sym3_unpaired`

✅ Checked when this page was built: SU7RealPairing.lean compiles with Lean 4.35.0, no errors, no sorry. Axioms — adjoint_vectorLike: propext, Classical.choice; adjoint_unpaired_eq_zero, adjoint_survivors_pp, adjoint_survivors_pm, sym2_unpaired, sym3_unpaired: propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound.

Reproduce: Lean 4.35.0, Mathlib f0b4c8150aa0; in that Lean project, `lake env lean SU7RealPairing.lean` (SHA-256 of the compiled file: `179d657feb7879fa`…; a source page on this site may show it with comments edited, under its own hash).

Trust base: 🔒 kernel only — **only part of the statement is formal** (see the box). Lean: 6 results, standard axioms only

🆕 **Classical and new:** not claimed as new: that adjoint matter is vector-like is stated as well known by Gogoladze–Mimura–Nandi [GMN], who cure it with a Z_3 projection; the paper claims the specialisation to the ± 1 diagonal parities, the counts and the chiral controls (§9).

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

Proof

For the adjoint $\mathbf{7} \otimes \bar{\mathbf{7}} - \mathbf{1}$ the conjugate of the component $(i, \bar{\jmath})$ is $(j, \bar{\imath})$, which lies in the *same* multiplet. Since the parities are diagonal, $P_5 P_5'(j, \bar{\imath}) = p_j p_i = P_5 P_5'(i, \bar{\jmath})$ and $P_5(j, \bar{\imath}) = P_{5,j} P_{5,i} = P_5(i, \bar{\jmath})$: the two survive together and with the same chirality. In an all-left-handed convention the two surviving Weyl fields transform in conjugate gauge representations and therefore admit a gauge-invariant Dirac mass — and their own prescription, a conjugate fixed-point fermion against each unwanted zero mode, supplies one. The argument uses no property of the Wilson line and none of the particular *values* of these parities — but it does use that they are ± 1 and diagonal,

> which is what makes the projection commute with conjugation, and that hypothesis is not free. A $\mathbb{Z}_3$ projection has complex eigenvalues, breaks the pairing, and is precisely how the literature obtains chiral families from an adjoint [13] . Their eqs. (37)–(40) are $\mathbb{Z}_2$, so that escape is closed in their model and not in general. □

💡 **In plain words (commentary, not part of the paper)**

1. When the orbifold parities are diagonal with entries ± 1, a bulk multiplet in a real representation, such as the adjoint $\mathbf{48}$, leaves only vector-like zero modes: no chiral state, whatever parities (η, η') it carries. So the $\mathbf{48}$ cannot host a lepton generation. 2. Why: the conjugate of the adjoint component $(i, \bar{\jmath})$ is $(j, \bar{\imath})$, in the same multiplet; with diagonal parities both components have the same parity products, so they survive together and with the same chirality, and the pair can be given a Dirac mass. Counted on the model's content: 18 of 18 surviving states paired in $\mathbf{48}^{(+,+)}$, 24 of 24 in $\mathbf{48}^{(+,-)}$; the control, the $\mathbf{28}$ and the $\mathbf{84}$, leaves 10 and 34 unpaired. 3. Not new as a mechanism, as the paper says: that adjoint matter is vector-like is stated as well known by Gogoladze, Mimura and Nandi, who cure it with a $\mathbb{Z}_3$ projection, unavailable with ± 1 parities. What matters here is the price: a $\mathbf{48}^{(+,+)}$ costs exactly $D = 0$, so had it been able to host the escape, case (3) would have paid nothing and the selection of case (2) would fail.

🛡️ **Evidence & scope**

- **Program:** the 48 at both parities: 18 of 18 and 24 of 24 surviving states paired with their conjugates; control: the 28 and the 84 leave 10 and 34 unpaired. `scripts/su7_adjoint_is_vectorlike.py`
- **Program:** the adversarial run that made the proposition necessary: the brane escape priced, every other gate open. `scripts/su7_brane_partner.py`

5 The bill, in eighths

No numbered statement in this section.

Its figures and tables are below; its text is in the paper, p. 11.

Figure 2

Komori-Maru Table 1, with the two conditions imposed. D is exact: every entry is a rational in eighths

	fermion content	$\alpha_{\min}$	m_h (GeV)	ν_R at -1	D	D after -84	D after -2×84	verdict
(1)	$\mathbf{28}^{(+,-)}+4\times\mathbf{84}^{(+,+)}$	0.043	126.8	no	+1.875	+0.625	-0.625	no ν_R
(2)	$\mathbf{28}^{(+,+)}+4\times\mathbf{84}^{(+,+)}$	0.081	125.5	yes	+3.625	+2.375	+1.125	UNIQUE ROW
(3)	$\mathbf{28}^{(+,+)}+3\times\mathbf{48}^{(+,+)}+2\times\mathbf{84}^{(+,+)}$	0.021	125.1	yes	+1.125	-0.125	-1.375	EWSB lost
(4)	$\mathbf{7}^{(+,-)}+2\times\mathbf{48}^{(+,+)}+3\times\mathbf{84}^{(+,+)}$	0.026	126.4	no	+1.375	+0.125	-1.125	no ν_R
(5)	$\mathbf{7}^{(+,+)}+\mathbf{7}^{(+,-)}+4\times\mathbf{84}^{(+,+)}$	0.043	126.2	no	+1.875	+0.625	-0.625	no ν_R

Table 1 of [1] with the two conditions of this paper imposed. The ν_R column is §??: which rows contain a Standard-Model singlet of $U(1)'$ charge -1, a statement about which components exist and therefore immune to everything in §??. The two D columns are §??, before and after donating one $\mathbf{84}^{(+,+)}$ to host the third lepton generation; every entry is an exact rational in eighths, and the coloured bar carries the sign, which is the whole content. Case (3) — the row [1] single out as *particularly interesting* — has only $9/8$ to spend against a cost of $10/8$. Generated by `make_figures_su7.py` from the archived `su7_repair_space.json`.

6 The selection rule is a half-line, not a tuning

Observation 2. (the permissive reading is theirs, not a licence we take) p. 14

> Three anomaly channels force $X_Q = -1/6$, and $-1/6$ is not a multiple of $1/2$. So, absent a Green–Schwarz mechanism, their own consistency forces the *permissive* reading of what may live at a fixed point — and the permissive reading is precisely what puts the dangerous point $A = 0$ within reach. Their construction already uses it: the reason they give for localising the quarks, in the sentence before their eq. (47), is that the fractional hypercharges of quarks cannot be obtained from tensor products of $\mathbf{7}$s. A brane field of theirs therefore already carries a charge off the bulk lattice — for hypercharge — and X_Q inherits exactly that freedom.

NEW **Classical and new:** the paper: «the permissive reading is theirs, not a licence we take»; their quarks are already localised for their fractional hypercharges (§6).

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

Proposition 3. (the rule in closed form) p. 14

> *Protection fails at q_φ iff $q_\varphi = |A_j|/n$ for some generation j and some integer $n \geq 1$. That set is countable and has a maximum, so protection is a half-line.*

Lean · ours, in part show

added to the Lean repository after publication (23-oct-2026): for A_j ≠ 0: protection fails at q iff q = |A_j|/n, n ≥ 1, and the failure set has maximum max_j |A_j|

- `GaugeHiggsUnification.SU7QPhi.fails_iff`
- `GaugeHiggsUnification.SU7QPhi.isGreatest_failSet`

✅ Checked when this page was built: SU7QPhiSelection.lean compiles with Lean 4.35.0, no errors, no sorry. Axioms — fails_iff, isGreatest_failSet: propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound.
Reproduce: Lean 4.35.0, Mathlib f0b4c8150aa0; in that Lean project, `lake env lean SU7QPhiSelection.lean` (SHA-256 of the compiled file: `39be48b8fd929263…`; a source page on this site may show it with comments edited, under its own hash).

Trust base: 🔒 kernel only — **only part of the statement is formal** (see the box). Lean: 2 results, standard axioms only

🆕 **Classical and new:** the mechanism (a residual discrete gauge symmetry from a broken U(1)) is Krauss–Wilczek and Ibáñez–Ross, and the leftover-U(1) breaking in gauge-Higgs unification is Dong [GHK]; the paper claims the closed-form rule for this model (§9).

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

💡 **In plain words (commentary, not part of the paper)**

1. A scalar of charge q_φ that breaks $U(1)'$ leaves a discrete symmetry, and an operator of charge A survives only if A/q_φ is an integer. So protection of the proton operators fails exactly when $q_\varphi = |A_j|/n$ for some generation j and some integer $n \geq 1$. That set of bad charges is countable and has a largest element: above it every charge protects, so protection is a half-line, not a fine tuning. 2. The paper checks the closed form against a brute scan of every rational $p/q \leq 2$ with $q \leq 36$ for all 14 assignments: 18 648 values, no disagreement. For the minimal assignment, with $A = (\frac{1}{6}, \frac{1}{6}, -\frac{1}{3})$, the bad set is $\{1/(3n)\}$, so all three charges the model can supply $(\frac{1}{2}, 1, \frac{3}{2})$ protect it. 3. And $q_\varphi = 3/2$, the charge of the pure index-7 component of the $\mathbf{84}$, forbids the four operators for every half-integer brane-quark charge, by a mod-3 argument, with preconditions the paper writes in: one condensing scalar only (any second one from the model's content collapses the residual group), a fixed normalisation, and only the dimension-6 operators. The mechanism (a residual discrete gauge symmetry) is Krauss–Wilczek and Ibáñez–Ross; the paper claims the closed-form rule for this model.

🛡️ **Evidence & scope**

- **Program:** closed form against a brute scan of every rational p/q ≤ 2 with q ≤ 36, for the 14 assignments: 18 648 values, 0 disagreements. `scripts/su7_qphi.py`
- **Program:** adversarial audit: qφ = 1/2 fails at every m, qφ = 1 at every odd m, qφ = 3/2 never. `scripts/su7_qphi_socratic.py`
- **Program:** the residual group and what a second condensing scalar does to it. `scripts/su7_residual_group.py`

7 The instrument, and where it fails

Observation 3.

(the exclusion list above is the one-loop list, and it is not the whole space) 📕 p. 17

Everything excluded in this section lives at one loop, and the three structural candidates named above are the one-loop candidates. There is a fourth: *loop order*. The Wilson-line potential is the Polyakov-loop potential of thermal gauge theory, where the two-loop

calculation is old. At two loops in pure gauge it is a multiplicative, background-independent rescaling of the one-loop result, $\Omega^{(2)}/\Omega^{(1)} = -5g^2C_2(A)/(16\pi^2)$ for any classical or exceptional group [22] — which is excluded here already, because the λ the $\alpha_{\min}$ column wants is not one number. With fermions that proportionality fails [23] , and the expressions carry Bernoulli polynomials of the individual background angles *and of their pairwise differences*. Those angles are the Wilson-line charges, so a product of two such structures generates cosines at $c_b \pm c_d$: with $c \in \{1, 2, 3\}$ that reaches $c \in \{0, \dots, 6\}$, and $4, 5, 6$ lie outside the set. Numerically $5g^2C_2(A)/(16\pi^2)$ is 7–14 % for $g_4 \in [0.55, 0.80]$ at $C_2(A) = 7$, against the 4–20 % rescaling the $\alpha_{\min}$ column asks for: *the same order*. We have not computed this term for this model and nothing here depends on it; what it establishes is that the list above is the one-loop list. It does not rescue Table 1 either, since their potential, their m_h and the finiteness that motivates gauge-Higgs unification are all one-loop statements. The bounded question it leaves is group-theoretic and needs no loop integral, and we answer it: *does the two-loop fermionic potential depend on the representation only through the multiset of its charges?* It does not. With $\mathrm{Tr}(T^aT^b) = \delta^{ab}/2$, their weight is exactly $2\sum_a |T^a_{ij}|^2$ on the fundamental, so the general-R replacement is forced to be $W(w, w') = \sum_a |\langle w|T^a_R|w'\rangle|^2$, whose row sums are $C_2(R)$; and $\mathbf{48}^{(+)}$ against $4 \times \mathbf{7}^{(+)} + \mathbf{7}^{(-)} + \mathbf{28}^{(+)}$ have identical one-loop term tables — hence identical F, $\alpha_{\min}$, m_h and D — with $\sum C_2$ of 7 against 24.8571. The one-loop potential is blind to the charge-zero states, so it fixes the Dynkin index and not the Casimir. Neither member of that pair is a Table 1 content, so nothing published here is separated by it.

> NEW **Classical and new:** the two-loop facts are Dumitru–Guo–Korthals Altes [DGKA] (pure gauge) and Guo–Du [GuoDu] (with fermions); the paper says «We have not computed this term for this model and nothing here depends on it», and answers only the group-theoretic question (two contents with identical one-loop tables and Σ C₂ of 7 against 24.8571).

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

Evidence & scope

- **Program:** the transplanted two-loop ratio against the wedge, with the control that a common rescaling returns exactly 1. `scripts/twoloop_wedge.py`
- **Numerical illustration (not a proof):** archived data only: the Casimirs and the colliding pairs 48(±) against 4×7 + 7 + 28 (Σ C₂ = 7 against 24.857); the script that wrote this file is not among the published scripts. `paper_data/su7_twoloop_weight.json`

Observation 4. (the guard lied first, and it is recorded) p. 18

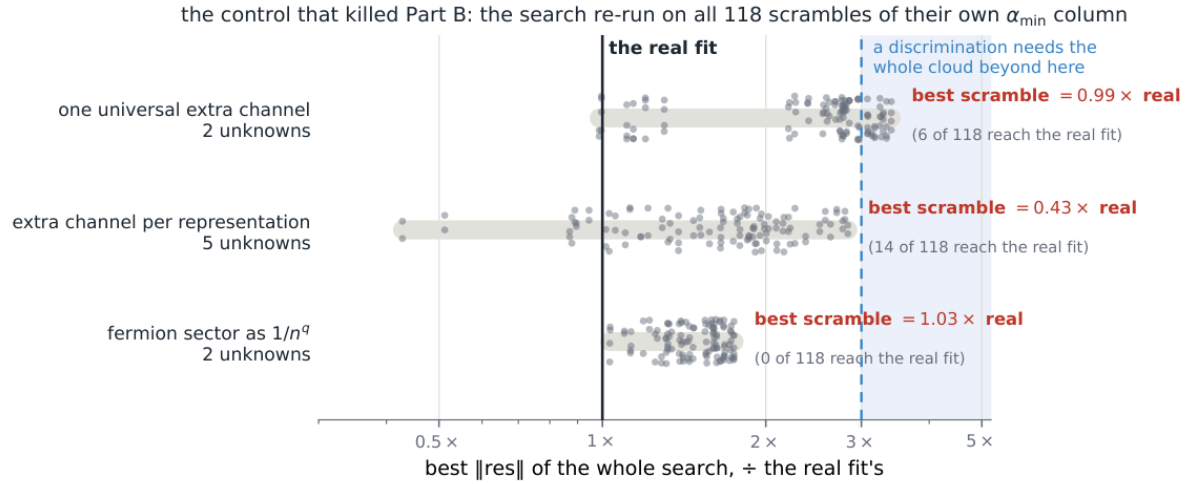
The first version of that control was this programme's usual one: fix (c, p, s) at the winner, reverse the $\alpha_{\min}$ column, re-solve. It returns ratios 3.41 and 3.51 and the verdict "informative" on tests that are dead. Scanning is itself a search, so a control that does not re-run the search measures nothing. Both the broken guard and the fix are in the archived output.

> NEW **Classical and new:** the paper records its own failed control: fixing the winner gave ratios 3.41 and 3.51 and the verdict «informative» on tests that are dead; both the broken guard and

> the fix are in the archived output (§7).

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

Figure 3



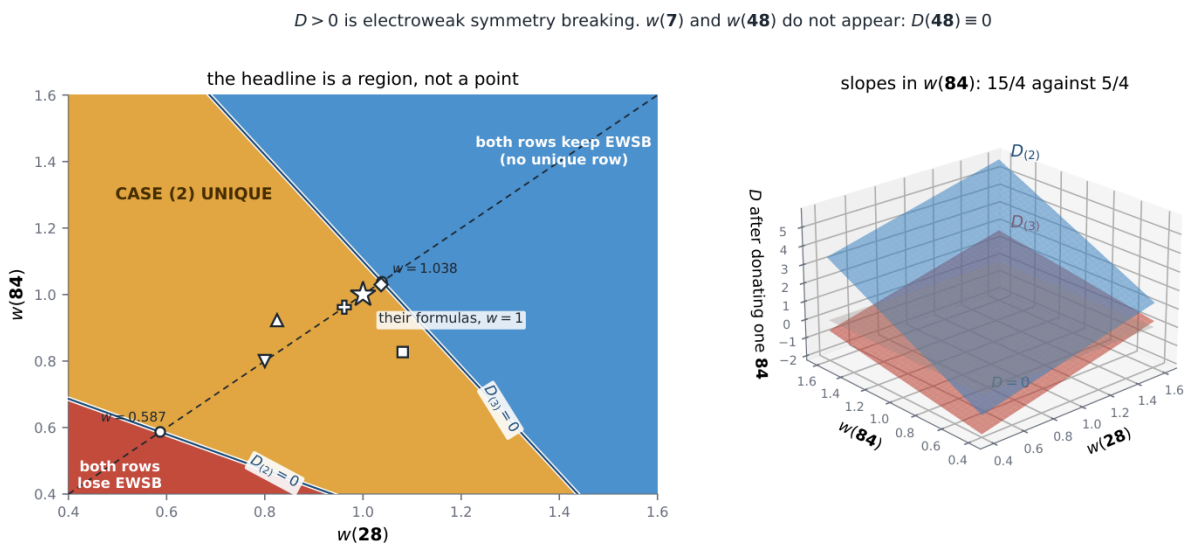
The control that decides §??'s last exclusion. Each candidate repair is a scan — one extra channel $v\sum_n s^n\cos(c\pi n\alpha)/n^p$ over $c\in[0.5,40]$, $p\in\{3,\dots,7\}$, $s=\pm1$, or the fermion sector run as $1/n^q$ — so the control must re-run the *whole scan* on scrambled data, not re-solve at the winning parameters. Grey dots: the best residual of the full search on each of the 118 non-trivial permutations of their own $\alpha_{\min}$ column, divided by the real fit's. A discrimination needs the whole cloud beyond the dashed threshold; every cloud instead straddles 1, and on two of the three tests the scrambled data *beats* the real data. Generated by `make_figures_su7.py`.

8 Why the discrepancy does not reach the conclusion

No numbered statement in this section.

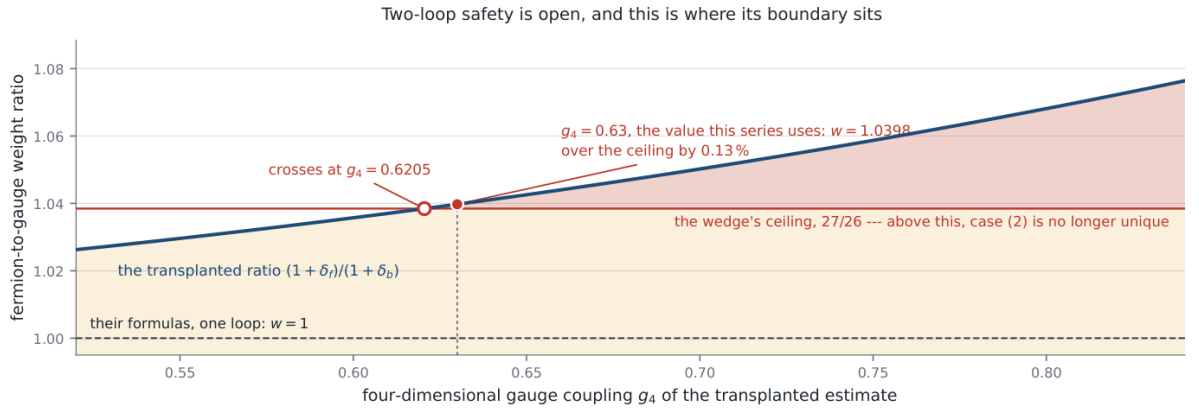
Its figures and tables are below; its text is in the paper, p. 19.

Figure 4



Left: the $(w(\mathbf{28}), w(\mathbf{84}))$ plane, coloured by verdict after donating one $\mathbf{84}^{(+,+)}$. The amber region is where case (2) survives and case (3) does not — the conclusion of this paper. Open marks are every repair the anchor discrepancy has ever been fitted to (§??); all of them lie inside it, and so does $w = 1$. The dashed diagonal carries the interval $(27/46,\ 27/26) = (0.587,\ 1.038)$, which reproduces the λ_{crit} of §?? by a different route. **Right:** why it is a wedge — D for the two rows is two planes over the same square, with slopes $15/4$ and $5/4$ in $w(\mathbf{84})$, and the conclusion is the slab between their zero sets. Generated by `make_figures_su7.py`.

Figure 5



Where the boundary of validity of this paper's verdict sits. The verdict is a statement about one number, the fermion-to-gauge weight ratio w; §?? shows it holds on the wedge, whose ceiling is $27/26$ (red). What the wedge does not absorb is loop order, so the curve is the transplanted two-loop ratio $(1+\delta_f)/(1+\delta_b)$ built from [22] 's gauge half and [23] 's fermionic one, against the four-dimensional coupling of those results. It crosses the ceiling at $g_4 = 0.6205$, and at the $g_4 = 0.63$ this series uses it sits $0.13\,\%$ above: on the *wrong* side, and by less than half a per cent. **Not drawn, and deliberately: the five row-by-row reweightings the $\alpha_{\min}$ column asks for.** They are a fit and not a measurement of w, the argument that used them is withdrawn on the previous page, and a figure may not keep making an argument the text has retracted. Drawn by `make_figures_su7.py` from the archived `twoloop_wedge.json`.

9 Attribution

No numbered statement in this section.

Its figures and tables are below; its text is in the paper, p. 23.

mechanism	status
the anomaly-free $U(1)$ extensions of the Standard Model are span$\{Y, B-L\}$, and gauged $B-L$ needs right-handed neutrinos of charge -1	textbook, forty years old
a gauged $B-L$ fails to forbid the $B-L$-conserving proton operators; the cure is a family-dependent $B-x_iL$	[7] , verbatim in its abstract; the dimension-6 statement is Weinberg and Wilczek–Zee [5 , 6]
placing families in different representations or at different fixed points of an orbifold GUT, and thereby suppressing proton decay	standard orbifold-GUT model building [14 , 15]
a broken extra $U(1)$ leaves a residual *discrete gauge* symmetry that can forbid the dimension-4, -5 and -6 proton operators	[8 , 9 , 10 , 11]
localised anomalies constrain brane charges, and Green–Schwarz can absorb mixed $U(1)$ ones	von Gersdorff–Quirós; Kojima–Takenaga–Yamashita [12] , which [1] cite as their ref. [13]
brane fields in orbifold GUTs need not furnish representations inherited from the bulk	standard practice; it is why their own quarks can be localised at all
matter in the adjoint — a real representation — is vector-like, and it is a $\mathbb{Z}_3$ projection that chiralises it	[13] , verbatim in its introduction: *"It is well known that… The matter in the adjoint representation is always vector-like, but one can project out the vector-like partner by a Z_3 transformation."* Proposition 2 is the specialisation to their ±1 diagonal parities, where that cure is unavailable; the counts and the chiral controls are ours
a leftover $U(1)$ in gauge-Higgs unification broken by a scalar with a vacuum expectation value of order $1/R$, with the surviving	[19] , eqs. (50)–(54), (77), (79) — the mechanism of §6 is theirs

charge read off the direction of that value	
no local brane Yukawa for the charged leptons in gauge-Higgs unification, and the obstruction is called generic	[16 , 17] — relevant to the rung-by-rung Yukawa closure of §4, which is why that closure is a control and not a result
a rule of thumb selecting the fermion content from the curvature of the Wilson-line potential *at the origin*	[18] . This is the closest prior art to §5: their Hessian factorises at $\alpha = 0$ and their selection rule is our arithmetic — **at the origin, and only there**. What is not theirs is the exact rational D per multiplet, and the donation cost that follows from it
minimality plus anomaly cancellation fixing the Standard-Model family content	[20] — background to §3, which is a relative statement inside a fixed model rather than a classification

Colour: red = no / fails.

10 Verification

No numbered statement in this section.

Its figures and tables are below; its text is in the paper, p. 24.

Table 1: Every claim of this paper against the evidence that carries it. The blocks are, in order: what is claimed; what is reported as *data* of [1] rather than as a defect; what is *open*; and what an earlier draft claimed and this one retracts.

Claim	Where, and on what
Three anomaly channels force $X_Q = -1/6$, which is exactly $A = 0$	§3; six channels, re-derived independently under Sage from the A_6 character ring
$U(1)' = T_{3L} + Y - (B - L)$ on every field, and all four operators have $Y = B - L = 0$	§3, an identity
Two channels cannot cancel and demand a singlet of charge -1; it exists in the **28** and nowhere else, so only rows (2),(3) supply it	§3; $\sum x = -1$ and $\sum x^3 = -1$ are independent
A **28** is *necessary* and not merely minimal: the solution set is $e = -1 - 4w$, $u = 5w$, so the net **28** number is never zero	§3; and a brute-force scan with no **28** returns nothing while the same scan with one condition dropped returns solutions

Only two of the fourteen assignments fit inside their own tensors, and both require charge -1	§4; rung ≥ 2 is unhostable — four boxes for the tensor powers, and for the $\mathbf{48}$, which is not one, no chiral zero mode. The fourteen are re-derived by an independent implementation
Proposition 2 — the mechanism is [13] 's, the specialisation ours: under their ± 1 diagonal parities a real representation furnishes no chiral generation, so the $\mathbf{48}$ cannot host the escape — and a $\mathbf{48}^{(+,+)}$ would have cost $D = 0$ exactly	§4, proved in three lines and counted in `su7_adjoint_is_vectorlike.py`, with the $\mathbf{28}$ and $\mathbf{84}$ as the control that must come out chiral and does (10 and 34 unpaired states). Case (3) holds three $\mathbf{48}$s, so this is a step and not an aside
Their eq. (81), quoted for the 5D $SU(4)$ model, is forced by their own eq. (54): the W carries Wilson-line charge $\frac{1}{2}$ and the photon 0	§2; the charge-1 modes exist, so the control is not vacuous
$\mathrm{extra}(L) = (1-k)/2$, and $\mathrm{extra}(L) + \mathrm{extra}(e^c) = 1/2$ on every rung	§4; rung 0 returns their own eq. (43)
Proposition 1: $[SU(2)_L]^2 U(1)' = \frac{1}{2}\sum_j A_j$	§4, exact; 14 assignments survive all six channels
Rung 1 is hosted by an $\mathbf{84}^{(+,+)}$, which is in every row of Table 1; the $\mathbf{35}$ cannot host it	§4, from their eqs. (37)–(40)
$V''(0) = -\pi^2\zeta(3)D$, D rational; $\mathbf{48}^{(+,+)} \mapsto 0$, $\mathbf{84}^{(+,+)} \mapsto 5/4$	§5; the truncation residual is *predicted* to 2 %
Case (2) is the only one of the five published rows that supplies the ν_R and survives the donation — within the minimal extension, at one-loop curvature	§3 + §5, Fig. 2; everything in eighths. A benchmark selected, not a model delivered: the modified potential is not recomputed. *Depends on their eq. (67)*: the verdict holds on $w \in [74/99, 118/151)$ and only $w = 3/4$ is admissible there
Proposition 3: protection fails iff $q_\varphi = \lvert A_j\rvert/n$; the set has a maximum	§6; 18 648 brute-scan values, 0 disagreements
$q_\varphi = 3/2$ forbids all four operators to all orders for every half-integer X_Q	§6; and $q_\varphi = 1/2$, 1 both fail, so it is not vacuous
$K = m_h\alpha_{\min}/\sqrt{F''(\alpha_{\min})}$ is row-independent, R_5, R_6, k cancelling	§7, verified symbolically
$D(\mathbf{48}) \equiv 0$, and the conclusion is a wedge containing $w = 1$ and every fitted repair	§8, Fig. 4; rebuilt from group theory in Sage

Their $\mathbf{48}$-subscripted terms in eq. (76) must be $\mathbf{84}$ terms, identified by a count	§7; the $\mathbf{84}$'s fifteen doublets come out only then
$F=\sum m\,\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Li}_5(s\,e^{ic\pi\alpha})$ and F'' a sum of $\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Li}_3$, with no truncation	§7, verified in Sage; it is what makes the 30-digit $F''(0.021)$ exact
Their eqs. (54),(41),(57),(69),(70) and their KK spectrum are derived, not assumed, and nothing in them is wrong	§2; $13/13$ structure constants, the omitted one exactly zero, charges $\{0,\pm\frac{1}{2},\pm1\}$ with multiplicities $26,20,2$
Their eq. (68) too: its three coefficients follow from the adjoint's (q,P_5P_5',P_6) table with two weights, $a=2$ and $b=\frac{1}{2}$	§2; overdetermined, and the two rows that fix a agree. This is the sector the wedge holds fixed, and it was the only one checked against nothing but their own eq. (62)
Unstated in their paper, reported as data and not as defects	**Where**
Their $\mathbf{28}$ is $\mathrm{Sym}^2(\bar{\mathbf{7}})$, the conjugate	§2; $4/4$ against $2/4$, and the test discriminates ($\mathbf{84}$: $10/10$ against $1/10$). Invisible to V_{eff}
$\pi_5=\pi_7$: the two indices the Wilson line mixes carry the same P_5P_5', without which their eq. (72) is not well defined	§2, §8; the first thing the Sage construction checks
Their spectrum requires a right-handed neutrino, not stated in their paper	§3
Their Table 1 is internally consistent: eq. (82) makes $1/R_5$ a function of $\alpha_{\min}$, and all five printed pairs agree	§7; a control on *their* table that could have fired. On rows (3),(4) the $1/R_5$ column is the sharper constraint
Open, and stated as open	**Why**
Their Table 1 $\alpha_{\min}$ is not reproduced from their eqs. (68), (72)–(76)	§7; gauge sector exact, truncation irrelevant, transcription verified three ways, no multiplicative or single-channel repair survives its control
Case (3) has $F''<0$ at its own published $\alpha_{\min}$ under our assembly	§7; exact to 30 digits, and the inflection is at $1.133\times$ that value
The exclusion list above is the *one-loop* list	§7, Observation 3. Two-loop pure gauge is multiplicative and therefore already excluded; with fermions it is not, and its size is the same order as the rescaling the $\alpha_{\min}$ column wants. Not computed here, and stated so

And so is the wedge: it tolerates $1/27$ of relative gauge-versus-fermion rescaling, and the published two-loop rescalings put the transplant *over* it at the nominal coupling	§8. With [23] 's fermionic half included, 0.78–1.72 times the margin over $g_4 \in [0.55, 0.80]$ — not the 1.8–3.8 of a gauge-only reading — crossing at $g_4 = 0.6205$ and at 1.033 at $g_4 = 0.63$. An earlier draft answered this with the anchor column; that answer is **withdrawn**
And both inputs of that estimate are four-dimensional and thermal	their group factors are this algebra, their loop integrals are not, and the $6/5$ is made of the latter. [22] add a limitation of their own, in their own words: they have *"not succeeded in finding a general proof"* of eq. (66) that avoids explicit evaluation, and do not know how the combinatorics works *inside* the Weyl chamber — their proof covers the straight paths from the origin to the $Z(N)$ minima, along its edges. An $\alpha_{\min} \simeq 0.05$ is on neither
The two rows that fail are exactly the two containing a $\mathbf{48}$, and the one satisfiable system asks for $w(\mathbf{48}) = 5.59$, $[5.20, 6.00]$ at $95\,\%$ under their own rounding	§7; confounded with their being the two smallest $\alpha_{\min}$, and five rows cannot separate the readings. Their eq. (75) is verified twice over, so no defect is claimed
The instrument is validated only *as an approach*	§7: Part V's independent implementation reproduces [2] exactly, but it is a different implementation, so it does not certify the $SU(7)$ assembly

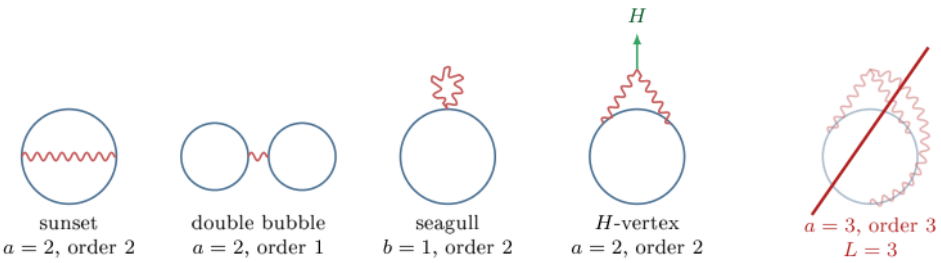
Retracted, and left visible	**Why**
"the exact eqs. (62)–(65) need $k \approx 1.2$"	never computed; a conclusion line printed as a literal string. The real correction is $1.5\,\%$ at $k = 1.2$. §7
"one extra channel repairs the anchor, and the control says it is informative"	the control fixed the winner instead of re-running the search. §7, Fig. 3

11 Open problems

No numbered statement in this section.

Its figures and tables are below; its text is in the paper, p. 27.

Figure 6



Why the two-loop group factor cannot be cubic. The loop number of a connected vacuum graph is $L = 1 + \frac{1}{2}\sum_k V_k(k-2)$, a function of the valences alone. Background legs (green) are external classical fields and carry weight zero, so they may be attached without limit — including at the three-gluon vertex that [24] name as the non-abelian frontier, fourth panel, which is a genuine two-loop diagram whose matter trace is nevertheless only $\mathrm{tr}_R(T^aT^b)$: its new structure lives in the gauge vertex, hence in the integral, not in the group factor. Only matter-gauge vertices carry both weight and a generator, so the trace order $a + 2b$ is bounded by the total weight 2. The fifth panel is the cheapest way to a cubic trace and it costs a third loop.

Data availability

No numbered statement in this section.

It is prose only (no statement, figure or table): read it in the paper (PDF).

Acknowledgements

No numbered statement in this section.

It is prose only (no statement, figure or table): read it in the paper (PDF).

Tables

Every table of the paper, in its order: click one to unfold it, with where the paper cites it, how its numbers were checked, and its data as CSV. The typeset table is one click away, on its page of the PDF.

Table without a number, in the text of §3 All six channels, and what they force

channel	coefficient, as a polynomial in X_Q	vanishes at
$[\mathrm{su}3_C]^2\,X$	0	every X_Q
$[\mathrm{su}2_L]^2\,X$	$\frac{3}{2}X_Q + \frac{1}{4}$	$X_Q = -1/6$
X^2Y	$-3X_Q - \frac{1}{2}$	$X_Q = -1/6$
XY^2	$-\frac{3}{2}X_Q - \frac{1}{4}$	$X_Q = -1/6$

$X \cdot \mathrm{grav}^2$	1	**never**
X^3	1	**never**

⬇ CSV

Table without a number, in the text of §4 A ladder inside their own \su7

k	**boxes**	L	$\mathrm{extra}(L)$	e_R **(their eq. (46):** $5 \leftrightarrow 7$**)**	$\mathrm{extra}(L) + \mathrm{extra}(e^c)$
0	2	$(5,6)$	$1/2$	$(6,7)$	$1/2$
1	3	$(5,6,7)$	0	$(6,7,7)$	$1/2$
2	4	$(5,6,7,7)$	$-1/2$	$(6,7,7,7)$	$1/2$

Colour: blue shade = the number's size within its column.

⬇ CSV

Table without a number, in the text of §4 A ladder inside their own \su7

representation	**rung** k	**hosted at**
\rep21, \rep28	0	$(\eta, \eta') = (-1, +1)$ — their own eq. (43)
$\rep35 = \Lambda^3$	1	**never** — $e_R = (6,7,7)$ needs a repeated index, which an antisymmetric tensor has not
\rep84	1	$(\eta, \eta') = (+1, +1)$
$\rep48 = \mathrm{adj}$	0, 2	**never** — it carries four lepton doublets, but $\langle A_5 \rangle$ takes none of them to a charged-lepton singlet

⬇ CSV

Table without a number, in the text of §5 The bill, in eighths

multiplet	D	**multiplet**	D
gauge sector	$-27/8$	$\rep28^{(+,+)}$	2
$\rep7^{(+,+)}$	$-3/4$	$\rep28^{(+,-)}$	$1/4$
$\rep7^{(+,-)}$	1	$\rep48^{(+,+)}$	**0**
		$\rep84^{(+,+)}$	**5/4**

⬇ CSV

Table without a number, in the text of §5 The bill, in eighths

case	D theirs	D after donating an \rep84	λ_{crit}	verdict
(1)	$15/8$	$5/8$	0.8438	EWSB survives
(2)	$\mathbf{29/8}$	$\mathbf{19/8}$	**0.5870**	**survives, largest margin of the five**
(3)	$\mathbf{9/8}$	$\mathbf{-1/8}$	**1.0385**	**EWSB LOST**: the symmetric point becomes the vacuum
(4)	$11/8$	$1/8$	0.9643	survives, barely
(5)	$15/8$	$5/8$	0.8438	EWSB survives

⬇ CSV

Table without a number, in the text of §9 Attribution

mechanism	status
the anomaly-free $U(1)$ extensions of the Standard Model are $\mathrm{span}\{Y, B-L\}$, and gauged $B-L$ needs right-handed neutrinos of charge -1	textbook, forty years old
a gauged $B-L$ fails to forbid the $B-L$-conserving proton operators; the cure is a family-dependent $B-x_i L$	[FamilyU1], verbatim in its abstract; the dimension-6 statement is Weinberg and Wilczek–Zee [Weinberg,WZ]
placing families in different representations or at different fixed points of an orbifold GUT, and thereby suppressing proton decay	standard orbifold-GUT model building [Raby,OrbGUT]
a broken extra $U(1)$ leaves a residual *discrete gauge* symmetry that can forbid the dimension-4, -5 and -6 proton operators	[KW,IR,DiscGauge,Orth]
localised anomalies constrain brane charges, and Green–Schwarz can absorb mixed $U(1)$ ones	von Gersdorff–Quirós; Kojima–Takenaga–Yamashita [KTY], which [KM25] cite as their ref. [13]
brane fields in orbifold GUTs need not furnish representations inherited from the bulk	standard practice; it is why their own quarks can be localised at all

matter in the adjoint — a real representation — is vector-like, and it is a $\mathbb{Z}_3$ projection that chiralises it	[GMN], verbatim in its introduction: *"It is well known that\ The matter in the adjoint representation is always vector-like, but one can project out the vector-like partner by a Z_3* transformation." Proposition 2 is the specialisation to their ± 1 diagonal parities, where that cure is unavailable; the counts and the chiral controls are ours
a leftover $U(1)$ in gauge-Higgs unification broken by a scalar with a vacuum expectation value of order $1/R$, with the surviving charge read off the direction of that value	[GHK], eqs. (50)–(54), (77), (79) — the mechanism of §6 is theirs
no local brane Yukawa for the charged leptons in gauge-Higgs unification, and the obstruction is called generic	[SSS,Maru19] — relevant to the rung-by-rung Yukawa closure of §4, which is why that closure is a control and not a result
a rule of thumb selecting the fermion content from the curvature of the Wilson-line potential *at the origin*	[AdachiMaru]. This is the closest prior art to §5: their Hessian factorises at $\alpha = 0$ and their selection rule is our arithmetic — **at the origin, and only there**. What is not theirs is the exact rational D per multiplet, and the donation cost that follows from it
minimality plus anomaly cancellation fixing the Standard-Model family content	[GengMarshak] — background to §3, which is a relative statement inside a fixed model rather than a classification

Colour: red = no / fails.

⬇ CSV

Table 1. Every claim of this paper against the evidence that carries it. The blocks are, in order: what is claimed; what is reported as *data* of [KM25] rather than as a defect; what is *open*; and what an earlier draft claimed and this one retracts.

Claim	Where, and on what
Three anomaly channels force $X_Q = -1/6$, which is exactly $A = 0$	§3; six channels, re-derived independently under Sage from the A_6 character ring
$U(1)' = T_{3L} + Y - (B - L)$ on every field, and all four operators have $Y = B - L = 0$	§3, an identity
Two channels cannot cancel and demand a singlet of charge -1; it exists in the \rep28 and nowhere else, so only rows (2),(3) supply it	§3; $\sum x = -1$ and $\sum x^3 = -1$ are independent
A \rep28 is *necessary* and not merely minimal: the solution set is	§3; and a brute-force scan with no \rep28 returns nothing while the same scan with one condition dropped returns solutions

$e = -1 - 4w$, $u = 5w$, so the net \rep28 number is never zero	
Only two of the fourteen assignments fit inside their own tensors, and both require charge -1	§4; rung ≥ 2 is unhostable — four boxes for the tensor powers, and for the \rep48, which is not one, no chiral zero mode. The fourteen are re-derived by an independent implementation
Proposition 2 — the mechanism is [GMN]'s, the specialisation ours: under their ± 1 diagonal parities a real representation furnishes no chiral generation, so the \rep48 cannot host the escape — and a $\rep48^{(+,+)}$ would have cost $D = 0$ exactly	§4, proved in three lines and counted in `su7_adjoint_is_vectorlike.py`, with the \rep28 and \rep84 as the control that must come out chiral and does (10 and 34 unpaired states). Case (3) holds three \rep48s, so this is a step and not an aside
Their eq. (81), quoted for the 5D \su4 model, is forced by their own eq. (54): the W carries Wilson-line charge $\frac{1}{2}$ and the photon 0	§2; the charge-1 modes exist, so the control is not vacuous
$\mathrm{extra}(L) = (1-k)/2$, and $\mathrm{extra}(L) + \mathrm{extra}(e^c) = 1/2$ on every rung	§4; rung 0 returns their own eq. (43)
Proposition 1: $[\su2_L]^2 U(1)' = \frac{1}{2}\sum_j A_j$	§4, exact; 14 assignments survive all six channels
Rung 1 is hosted by an $\rep84^{(+,+)}$, which is in every row of Table 1; the \rep35 cannot host it	§4, from their eqs. (37)–(40)
$V''(0) = -\pi^2\zeta(3)D$, D rational; $\rep48^{(+,+)} \mapsto 0$, $\rep84^{(+,+)} \mapsto 5/4$	§5; the truncation residual is *predicted* to 2 %
Case (2) is the only one of the five published rows that supplies the ν_R and survives the donation — within the minimal extension, at one-loop curvature	§3 + §5, Fig. 2; everything in eighths. A benchmark selected, not a model delivered: the modified potential is not recomputed. *Depends on their eq. (67)*: the verdict holds on $w \in [74/99, 118/151)$ and only $w = 3/4$ is admissible there
Proposition 3: protection fails iff $q_\varphi = \lvert A_j\rvert/n$; the set has a maximum	§6; 18 648 brute-scan values, 0 disagreements
$q_\varphi = 3/2$ forbids all four operators to all orders for every half-integer X_Q	§6; and $q_\varphi = 1/2$, 1 both fail, so it is not vacuous
$K = m_h\alpha_{\min}/\sqrt{F''(\alpha_{\min})}$ is row-independent, R_5, R_6, k cancelling	§7, verified symbolically
$D(\rep48) \equiv 0$, and the conclusion is a wedge containing $w = 1$ and every fitted repair	§8, Fig. 4; rebuilt from group theory in Sage

Their \rep48-subscripted terms in eq. (76) must be \rep84 terms, identified by a count	§7; the \rep84's fifteen doublets come out only then
$F = \sum m \,\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Li}_5(s\,e^{ic\pi\alpha})$ and F'' a sum of $\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Li}_3$, with no truncation	§7, verified in Sage; it is what makes the 30-digit $F''(0.021)$ exact
Their eqs. (54),(41),(57),(69),(70) and their KK spectrum are derived, not assumed, and nothing in them is wrong	§2; $13/13$ structure constants, the omitted one exactly zero, charges $\{0, \pm\frac{1}{2}, \pm 1\}$ with multiplicities $26, 20, 2$
Their eq. (68) too: its three coefficients follow from the adjoint's (q, P_5P_5', P_6) table with two weights, $a = 2$ and $b = \frac{1}{2}$	§2; overdetermined, and the two rows that fix a agree. This is the sector the wedge holds fixed, and it was the only one checked against nothing but their own eq. (62)
Unstated in their paper, reported as data and not as defects	**Where**
Their \rep28 is $\mathrm{Sym}^2(\bar{\rep 7})$, the conjugate	§2; $4/4$ against $2/4$, and the test discriminates (\rep84: $10/10$ against $1/10$). Invisible to V_{eff}
$\pi_5 = \pi_7$: the two indices the Wilson line mixes carry the same P_5P_5', without which their eq. (72) is not well defined	§2, §8; the first thing the Sage construction checks
Their spectrum requires a right-handed neutrino, not stated in their paper	§3
Their Table 1 is internally consistent: eq. (82) makes $1/R_5$ a function of $\alpha_{\min}$, and all five printed pairs agree	§7; a control on *their* table that could have fired. On rows (3),(4) the $1/R_5$ column is the sharper constraint
Open, and stated as open	**Why**
Their Table 1 $\alpha_{\min}$ is not reproduced from their eqs. (68),(72)–(76)	§7; gauge sector exact, truncation irrelevant, transcription verified three ways, no multiplicative or single-channel repair survives its control
Case (3) has $F'' < 0$ at its own published $\alpha_{\min}$ under our assembly	§7; exact to 30 digits, and the inflection is at $1.133\times$ that value
The exclusion list above is the *one-loop* list	§7, Observation 3. Two-loop pure gauge is multiplicative and therefore already excluded; with fermions it is not, and its size is the same order as the rescaling the $\alpha_{\min}$ column wants. Not computed here, and stated so
And so is the wedge: it tolerates $1/27$ of relative gauge-versus-fermion rescaling, and the published two-loop rescalings put the transplant *over* it at the nominal coupling	§8. With [GuoDu]'s fermionic half included, 0.78–1.72 times the margin over $g_4 \in [0.55, 0.80]$ — not the 1.8–3.8 of a gauge-only reading — crossing at $g_4 = 0.6205$ and at 1.033 at $g_4 = 0.63$. An earlier draft answered this with the anchor column; that answer is **withdrawn**

And both inputs of that estimate are four-dimensional and thermal	their group factors are this algebra, their loop integrals are not, and the $6/5$ is made of the latter. [DGKA] add a limitation of their own, in their own words: they have *"not succeeded in finding a general proof"* of eq. (66) that avoids explicit evaluation, and do not know how the combinatorics works *inside* the Weyl chamber — their proof covers the straight paths from the origin to the $Z(N)$ minima, along its edges. An $\alpha_{\min} \simeq 0.05$ is on neither
The two rows that fail are exactly the two containing a \rep48, and the one satisfiable system asks for $w(\rep48) = 5.59$, $[5.20, 6.00]$ at $95\,\%$ under their own rounding	§7; confounded with their being the two smallest $\alpha_{\min}$, and five rows cannot separate the readings. Their eq. (75) is verified twice over, so no defect is claimed
The instrument is validated only *as an approach*	§7: Part V's independent implementation reproduces [AHMN] exactly, but it is a different implementation, so it does not certify the \su7 assembly
Retracted, and left visible	**Why**
"the exact eqs. (62)–(65) need $k \approx 1.2$ "	never computed; a conclusion line printed as a literal string. The real correction is $1.5\,\%$ at $k = 1.2$. §7
"one extra channel repairs the anchor, and the control says it is informative"	the control fixed the winner instead of re-running the search. §7, Fig. 3

p. 24 in the PDF ⬇ CSV not cited in the text

References

1 Y. Komori, N. Maru, *$SU(7)$ Grand Gauge-Higgs Unification*, NITEP 240, arXiv:2503.04090.

2 K. Akamatsu, T. Hirose, N. Maru, A. Nago, *Electroweak Symmetry Breaking in Two Higgs Doublet Model from 6D Gauge-Higgs Unification on $T^2/\mathbb{Z}_2$*, arXiv:2312.08608.

3 N. S. Manton, *A new six-dimensional approach to the Weinberg–Salam model*, Nucl. Phys. **B158** (1979) 141. 🔎 find it

4 Y. Hosotani, Phys. Lett. **B126** (1983) 309; Ann. Phys. (N.Y.) **190** (1989) 233. 🔎 find it

5 S. Weinberg, Phys. Rev. Lett. **43** (1979) 1566. 🔎 find it

6

F. Wilczek, A. Zee, Phys. Rev. Lett. **43** (1979) 1571. 🔎 find it

7

H.-S. Lee, E. Ma, *Gauged $B - x_i L$ origin of R parity and its implications*, arXiv:1001.0768. The family-dependent cure for a $B - L$ that cannot forbid the $B - L$-conserving proton operators is stated verbatim in its abstract.

8

L. M. Krauss, F. Wilczek, *Discrete gauge symmetry in continuum theories*, Phys. Rev. Lett. **62** (1989) 1221. 🔎 find it

9

L. E. Ibáñez, G. G. Ross, Nucl. Phys. **B368** (1992) 3. 🔎 find it

10

H.-S. Lee, C. Luhn, K. T. Matchev, *Discrete gauge symmetries and proton stability in the $U(1)'$-extended MSSM*, JHEP **07** (2008) 065. 🔎 find it

11

A. Aranda, C. D. Carone, *Orthogonal $U(1)$'s, proton stability and extra dimensions*, hep-ph/0012092. 🔎 find it

12

K. Kojima, K. Takenaga, T. Yamashita, arXiv:1704.04840 — cited by [1] as their ref. [13].

13

I. Gogoladze, Y. Mimura, S. Nandi, *Model building with gauge-Yukawa unification*, Phys. Rev. **D69** (2004) 075006, hep-ph/0311127 — where the adjoint's vector-like character is stated as well known and the Z_3 cure is named. 🔎 find it

14

S. Raby, *Grand Unified Theories*, hep-ph/0608183 — cited as a review of the field; the orbifold constructions this paper actually leans on are [15] .

15

A. Kobakhidze, *Proton stability in 5D GUTs with orbifold compactification*, hep-ph/0108049; A. Hebecker, J. March-Russell, *Proton decay signatures of orbifold GUTs*, hep-ph/0204037. 🔎 find it

16

C. A. Scrucca, M. Serone, L. Silvestrini, hep-ph/0304220 — [2] 's own ref. [19].

17

N. Maru, arXiv:1903.08359 — where the charged-lepton Yukawa obstruction is called generic in gauge-Higgs unification.

18

T. Adachi, N. Maru, Phys. Rev. **D98** (2018) 015022, arXiv:1804.06012.

19

P. V. Dong, *A possible minimal gauge-Higgs unification*, arXiv:1105.0541, eqs. (50)–(54), (77), (79).

20

C. Q. Geng, R. E. Marshak, Phys. Rev. **D39** (1989) 693. 🔎 find it

21

D. B. Costa, B. A. Dobrescu, P. J. Fox, *General Solution to the $U(1)$ Anomaly Equations*, Phys. Rev. Lett. **123** (2019) 151601, arXiv:1905.13729 — the gravitational and cubic conditions as a Diophantine system, solved in general.

22

A. Dumitru, Y. Guo, C. P. Korthals Altes, Phys. Rev. **D89** (2014) 016009, arXiv:1305.6846, eq. (66); and Bhattacharya, Gocksch, Korthals Altes, Pisarski, Nucl. Phys. **B383** (1992) 497.

23

Y. Guo, Q. Du, JHEP **05** (2019) 042, arXiv:1810.13090.

24

Y. Hosotani, N. Maru, K. Takenaga, T. Yamashita, *Two loop finiteness of Higgs mass and potential in the gauge-Higgs unification*, Prog. Theor. Phys. **118** (2007) 1053, arXiv:0709.2844 — the only two-loop Wilson-line potential in this framework, and Abelian.

25

C. Marín, *Anomaly- and Tadpole-Compatible Fermion Completion of Six-Dimensional $SU(4)$ Gauge–Higgs Unification*, Part I, doi:10.5281/zenodo.21432625.

26

C. Marín, *Three Gates to a Quark Generation: an exact criterion for which $SU(4)$ representations contain the Standard Model*, Part II, doi:10.5281/zenodo.21432627.

27

C. Marín, *A Centre-Charge Selection Rule for the Wilson-Line Potential*, Part III, doi:10.5281/zenodo.21438226.

28

C. Marín, *Schur Functions at $(1,-1,t,t^{-1})$: a closed form on the non-identity component of $O(4)$*, Part IV, doi:10.5281/zenodo.21463000.

29

C. Marín, *The compactification scale of $SU(7)$ grand gauge-Higgs unification is bounded*, Part VII of this series, to appear. 🔎 find it

30

C. Marín, *What the Higgs Potential Cannot See: bulk matter that cannot help select a boundary condition*, Part V, doi:10.5281/zenodo.21727094.